Using golden dandelions to unlock aging forcibly removes persistence of baby animals

MC-306328 Mob spawning

Status	Resolved / Fixed
Affected	26.1 Snapshot 7, 26.1 Snapshot 9, 26.1 Snapshot 10
Fixed in	26.1 Pre-Release 2
Reported	2026-02-11

STEPS TO REPRODUCE

1. Spawn, summon, or encounter a baby animal.
2. Run `/data get entity <baby animal> AgeLocked` and verify that the value is `0b`.
3. Run `/data get entity <baby animal> PersistenceRequired` and verify that the value is `0b`.
4. Use a named Name Tag item on the baby animal.
5. Run `/data get entity <baby animal> PersistenceRequired` and verify that the value is `1b`.
6. Use a Golden Dandelion item on the baby animal to lock its aging.
7. Run `/data get entity <baby animal> AgeLocked` and verify that the value is `1b`.
8. Use a second Golden Dandelion item on the baby animal to unlock its aging.
9. Run `/data get entity <baby animal> AgeLocked` and `/data get entity <baby animal> PersistenceRequired`.
10. Observe that `AgeLocked` is `0b`, but `PersistenceRequired` has incorrectly changed to `0b` even though the baby animal still has a name applied.

OBSERVED BEHAVIOUR

After the second Golden Dandelion unlocks the baby animal's growth, its `AgeLocked` value correctly changes from `1b` to `0b`. However, the interaction also changes `PersistenceRequired` from `1b` to `0b`, even though the animal still has a custom name applied with a Name Tag.

As a result, unlocking the animal's aging incorrectly removes its persistent-mob status, allowing the named baby animal to despawn under normal despawning conditions.

EXPECTED BEHAVIOUR

After the baby animal's aging is unlocked, its AgeLocked value should return to 0b while its PersistenceRequired value remains 1b because it has a name tag. Removing the age lock should not remove persistence granted by the name tag, and the named baby animal should remain protected from despawning after the Golden Dandelion is used.

ENVIRONMENT

Minecraft Java Edition Versions: 26.1 Snapshot 7, 26.1 Snapshot 9, 26.1 Snapshot 10 (includes snapshots)

ORIGINAL DESCRIPTION

Using a Golden Dandelion on a baby animal that is age locked in order to remove the age lock will also remove its persistence, even if the animal should remain persistent due to other factors. (most notably, having a name tag applied to it)

This is caused by the method setAgeLocked in the AgeableMob class calling mob.setPersistenceRequired while only taking into account the age locking itself, and not other factors that should result in persistence.

Steps to reproduce:

- Spawn, summon, or encounter a baby animal

- Use the /data get entity command to verify that its AgeLocked value is 0b, and its PersistenceRequired value is also 0b

- Use a named Name Tag item to apply a name to the mob

- Use the /data get entity command to verify that its PersistenceRequired value has now become 1b, as expected, indicating the mob will no longer despawn

- Use a Golden Dandelion item to lock the baby's aging

- Use the /data get entity command to verify that its AgeLocked value has now become 1b, as expected

- Use a second Golden Dandelion item to unlock the baby's aging

Expected Result:

- Using the /data get entity command, you'll see its AgeLocked value has returned to 0b as expected, and its PersistenceRequired value has remained 1b due to the baby having a name tag applied, preventing it from despawning

Actual Result:

- Using the /data get entity command, you'll see its AgeLocked value has returned to 0b as expected, however its PersistenceRequired value has also become 0b, meaning the baby can despawn again despite still having a name tag applied

MANUAL RESULT

Version used	
Reproduced?	YES / NO / PARTIAL
Crash file	
Notes	
Tested by / date	

Live issue: https://bugs.mojang.com/browse/MC/issues/MC-306328